

X's mission, in X's own words



Nikita Bier ✓
@nikitabier



People come X to get a pulse on humanity. Because of that, the platform must make every effort to resist anything that misrepresents or adulterates that pulse.

There is nothing more unsettling than expecting you're reading the words of a human -- only to find it was a machine, or an account operating at the direction of an undisclosed commercial or governmental entity.

In the AI era, our product, policies, and approach will need to evolve meaningfully. Some things may not work, but we intend to employ every available tool and strategy to secure the global town square.

Feb 22, 2026

x.com/nikitabier/status/2025712861650305512

A game

THE PRODUCT EXPRESSION OF THAT MISSION

X is already at war with slop

N

Nikita Bier ✓

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X

We found 42,000 accounts automating replies using chatbots and have removed them from the platform.

X's core value is providing an authentic pulse on humanity -- and using AI to programmatically engage with users without a human in the loop runs counter to our mission.

Jul 24, 2026

x.com/nikitabier/status/2080747924380856519

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X

We have a common enemy: the slop-ocalypse

Jul 31, 2026

x.com/nikitabier/status/2083254001014120458

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X

We are revising our developer API policies:

We will no longer allow apps that reward users for posting on X (aka "infofi"). This has led to a tremendous amount of AI slop & reply spam on the platform.

Jan 15, 2026

x.com/nikitabier/status/2011825522817270230

42,000

CHATBOT ACCOUNTS REMOVED, REPORTED

0

GAMES SHIPPED BY X IN 20 YEARS

Unshipped

THE 2026 AI-GAME PROMISE

Decoy: spot the machine in 30 seconds

- One real trending thread, pulled live from X
- Four real replies plus one Grok-written imposter
- TEXT rounds and GIF rounds, where the fake is Imagine video
- Six-round matches with a results screen, then play again
- Reveal shows every player's pick and the machine's tell

6 rounds

MATCH LENGTH

30s

ROUND CLOCK

12

TOPIC ROUNDS BUILT



• SCAN AND PLAY

Let's play

Scan the QR, you are in the game · No host: the session clock runs the room · Solo works, a crowd works, latecomers just land in the next beat

GROK

ROOM CODE

30s

ON THE CLOCK

6 rounds

MATCH

- X_SEARCH TO REVEAL

Live thread in, **five gates** before play



Gates rejected 1 of 6 rounds built today (G_SOURCE + G_URL), so 5 serve

Proven offline: full two-player round, zero network egress (artifacts/integration_trace.txt)

42s

X_SEARCH PROBE

6.5s

IMAGE GEN PROBE

1.78s

TTS PROBE

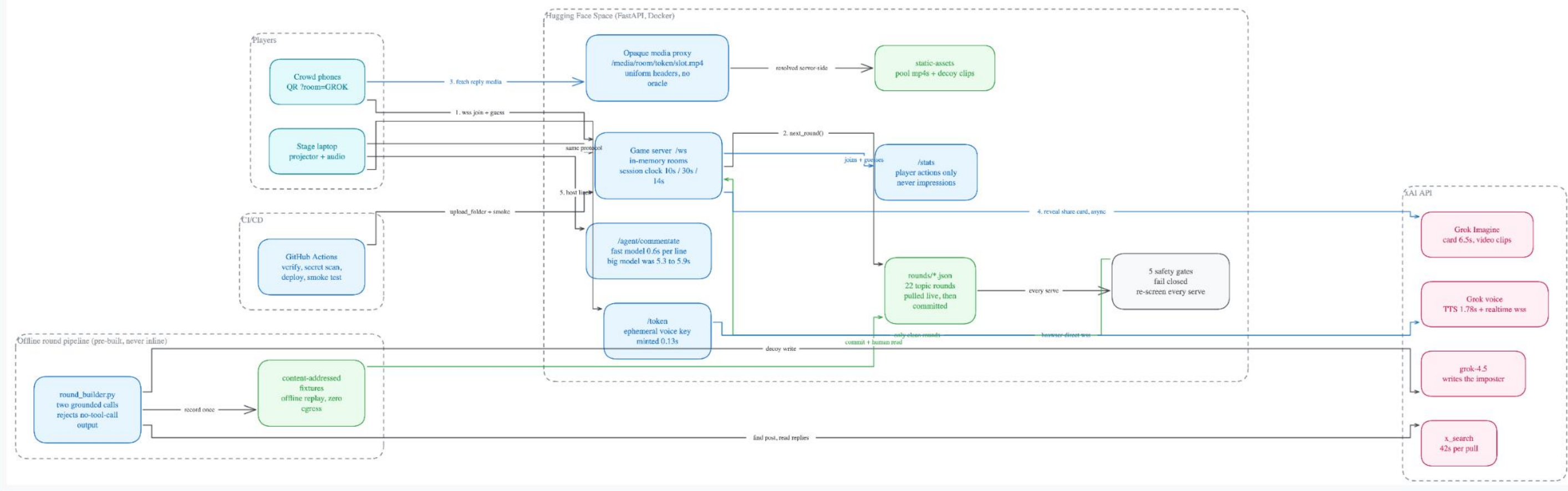
0.6s

COMMENTATOR LINE, FAST MODEL

- ONE PAGE, EVERY MOVING PART

One server, an offline pipeline, xAI behind it

X Arcade / Decoy: system design



One game server, an offline round pipeline, and the xAI surfaces behind it. Numbered flows: 1 join and guess over wss, 2 serve a gated round, 3 fetch opaque media, 4 attach the Imagine card async, 5 host lines. Latencies are measured probes.

The hard parts were correctness under load

- Grounded two-call pull that rejects any answer with no search call
- Opaque uniform media so the decoy cannot be found by inspection
- Time-driven session machine, no host, so no dead-button race
- Offline demo with a socket guard proving zero network egress
- 32-check abuse battery, malformed frames to a 30-player room

GATE	WHAT IT CHECKS
G_SOURCE	post and all 5 replies present, within length bounds
G_SLURS	denylist scan over the post and every reply
G_DECOY_COUNT	exactly one imposter, and the round points at it
G_AUTHOR	real replies carry real handles, never the decoy marker
G_URL	no links in reply text

32/32

ABUSE BATTERY

5

SAFETY GATES, FAIL CLOSED

0

NETWORK EGRESS, OFFLINE PROOF

24

TOPIC ROUNDS

What broke, and what it taught us

- Host-driven rooms gave three dead-button bugs, so we deleted the host and went time-driven
- The GIF decoy leaked three ways, so media now serves through one opaque proxy
- The Space said RUNNING while hung, so the runbook is restart, not redeploy
- Live pulls kept hitting culture-war threads that pass the gates, so every fresh round gets a human read
- A shuffle broke the test suites and byte-replay, so the suites pin it and the shuffle got its own invariants

3

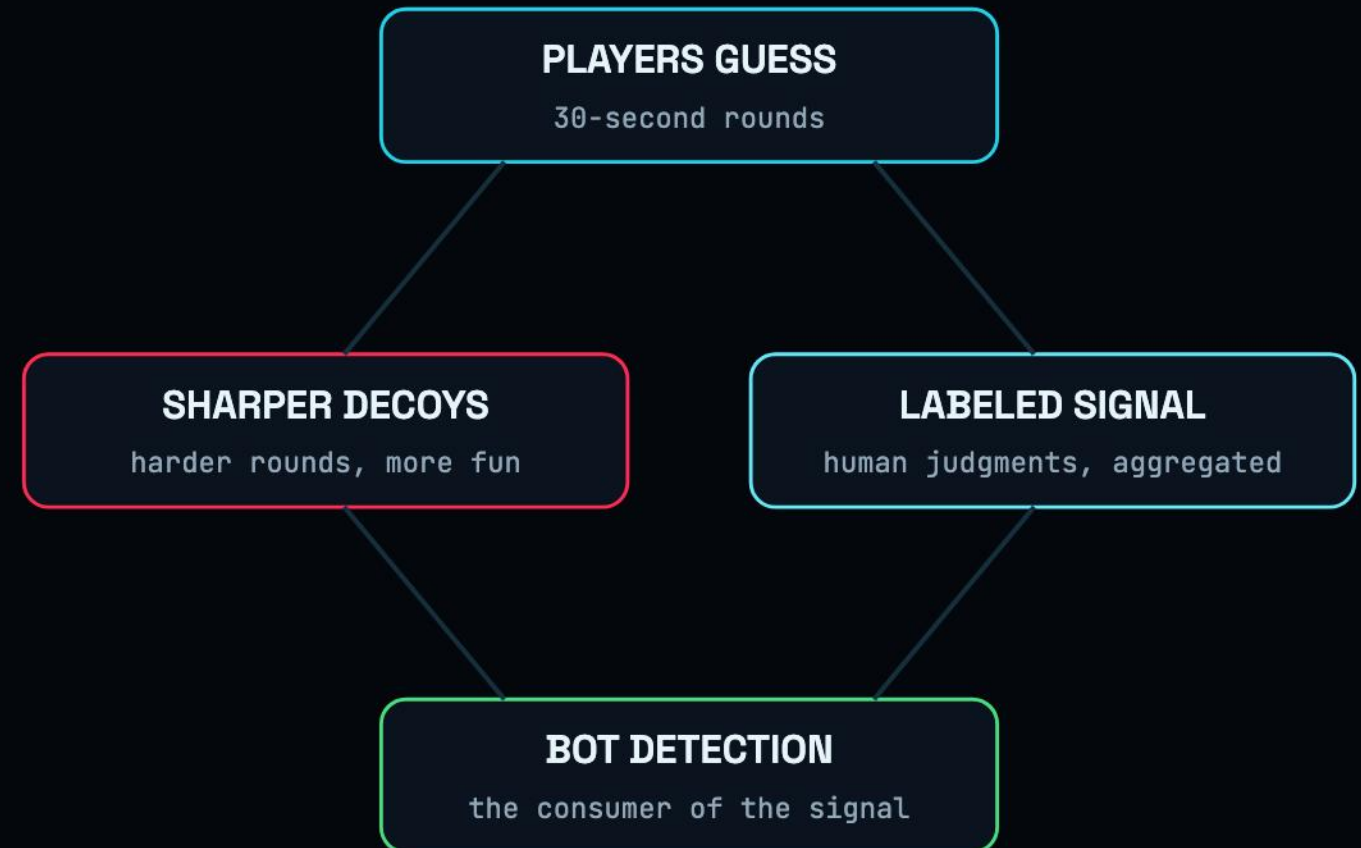
DEAD-BUTTON BUGS, ONE DAY

3

WAYS THE DECOY LEAKED

Every guess is a **labeled judgment**

- A guess marks which reply reads machine-written
- Wrong guesses flag real people who read like bots
- Aggregate signal is what no-human-in-the-loop enforcement needs
- This is a thesis. No flywheel number is measured.



Thesis

LABELED AS SUCH

0

FLYWHEEL METRICS MEASURED

One cabinet, many cartridges

- A cartridge ships rounds behind one small contract
- The cabinet runs rooms, clocks, scoring, voice, share cards
- Gates are platform infrastructure, not per-game code
- A rejected round is the screen working

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5

GATES, FAIL CLOSED

1

EVENT-DAY PULL GATED ON G_URL

Sponsored arenas, shareable wins

- Brands sponsor a topic arena with a light skin
- The winner's share card carries the sponsor mark
- Gates screen every round before a brand touches it
- Every revenue figure is illustrative, none is measured



Imagine-generated share card, a committed demo asset. The card a winner would post back to X. The demo stages that post-back rather than posting live.

ILLUSTRATIVE

AD MODULE CPM FIELD

Fictional

DEMO SPONSOR NAMES

Built in **a day** on the API

- Live and playable now: github.com/arunshar/x-arcade-grokathon, MIT
- Usage is public and honest at /stats: actions, never impressions
- Post-back is staged and said so; realtime voice is live-mode
- The ask: ship one cartridge on X, instrument the guess stream

MIT

LICENSE

1 day

ON THE XAI API